BRAND GUIDELINES

Byte-Sized Wisdom

AI Consulting · Brand Identity · Web Design

Version 1.0 · 2025 · Sample Document · aaronzajicek.com

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

This is a sample Brand Guidelines document produced by Byte-Sized Wisdom. It demonstrates the depth, structure, and quality of deliverable that every BSW branding client receives — built here around the Byte-Sized Wisdom brand itself.

A Brand Guidelines document is the single source of truth for your visual and verbal identity — covering logo usage, color values, typography, tone of voice, and every real-world application of your brand. If you are interested in a document like this for your business, visit aaronzajicek.com.

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01

Brand Foundation

Who we are and why we exist

1.1 Mission

To help small businesses, startups, and entrepreneurs modernize their brand, integrate AI into their operations, and build a professional digital presence — so they can compete with larger players and win.

1.2 Vision

A world where any business, regardless of size, has access to the kind of strategic branding and technology sophistication that was once reserved for enterprise companies.

1.3 Brand Story

Byte-Sized Wisdom was founded on a simple observation: most small businesses are better at what they do than they look doing it. Their products and services are excellent. Their branding tells a different story.

The business emerged from a Computer Information Systems background — a rare combination of technical depth and design sensibility that most branding agencies don't have, and most tech agencies don't care about. The name reflects the philosophy: complex ideas, delivered in clear, manageable pieces.

We operate at the intersection of AI, brand strategy, and web development — three disciplines that, in 2025, must work together for any business to be taken seriously online.

1.4 Core Values

Clarity	We communicate with precision. If something can be said in fewer words without losing meaning, it should be. Every design decision and every sentence is tested against this.
Integrity	We only take on work we believe in and deliver results we're proud to put our name on. We won't recommend a solution we wouldn't use ourselves.
Systems	We don't design one-off moments — we build brand systems that scale. Everything we create is documented, consistent, and designed to grow with the business.

Curiosity	We stay at the frontier of AI, design, and technology so our clients don't have to. Continuous learning is a professional obligation, not an optional activity.
Accountability	If something isn't working, we say so. If we make a mistake, we fix it. Clients deserve honest partners, not vendors who protect their invoices.

1.5 Brand Promise

> **Our promise to every client:**
> You will end every project with a brand system that is more professional, more consistent, and more strategically grounded than what you started with — or we keep working until it is.

1.6 Target Audience

BSW serves three primary audience segments. Understanding these personas is essential for anyone creating BSW-branded content — the brand must resonate with these specific people.

Persona 1 — The Established Owner

Who	Small business owner, 35–55, been operating 3–10 years. Strong in their trade, struggling with digital presence.
Pain point	'I know we do great work but our website looks like 2012 and we lose clients to competitors who look more professional.'
What they need	Trust signals. A brand that matches the quality of their actual service. Clear, modern web presence.
How BSW speaks	Direct, no-jargon. Focus on ROI and business outcomes. Acknowledge that they're already good — we just need to make sure it shows.

Persona 2 — The Startup Founder

Who	Tech or e-commerce founder, 25–40, pre-revenue to Series A. Has product-market fit questions but knows branding matters.
Pain point	'We're building fast but our brand is inconsistent — Canva logo, different colors on every slide, no guidelines. Investors notice.'
What they need	A scalable brand system. Guidelines that contractors can follow. Speed and quality simultaneously.
How BSW speaks	Technical peers. Speak the language of systems, scalability, and investment-readiness. Fast turnaround messaging.

Persona 3 — The AI-Curious Operator

Who	Operations manager or business owner who reads about AI constantly but hasn't implemented anything meaningful.
Pain point	'I know AI can save us time but I don't know where to start or what to actually automate.'
What they need	Practical guidance. Specific workflow recommendations. Someone who can bridge the gap between AI hype and actual implementation.
How BSW speaks	Patient, practical, no hype. Give concrete examples. Acknowledge the overwhelm and offer clarity.

1.7 Competitive Positioning

BSW is not positioned against large agencies — we don't compete for $100K+ brand projects. Our competitive set is the fragmented landscape of freelance designers on Fiverr/Upwork, generic website builders like Squarespace, and DIY AI tools.

	Typical Freelancer	Byte-Sized Wisdom
Strategic thinking	Design execution only	Brand strategy first, design second
AI knowledge	Rarely	Core service offering
Systems delivery	Single deliverables	Full documented systems
Technical depth	Design tools	CIS background + dev capability
Brand guidelines	Extra charge or skipped	Standard deliverable
Communication	Inconsistent	Direct, accountable, documented

02

Logo System

How to use the BSW mark correctly

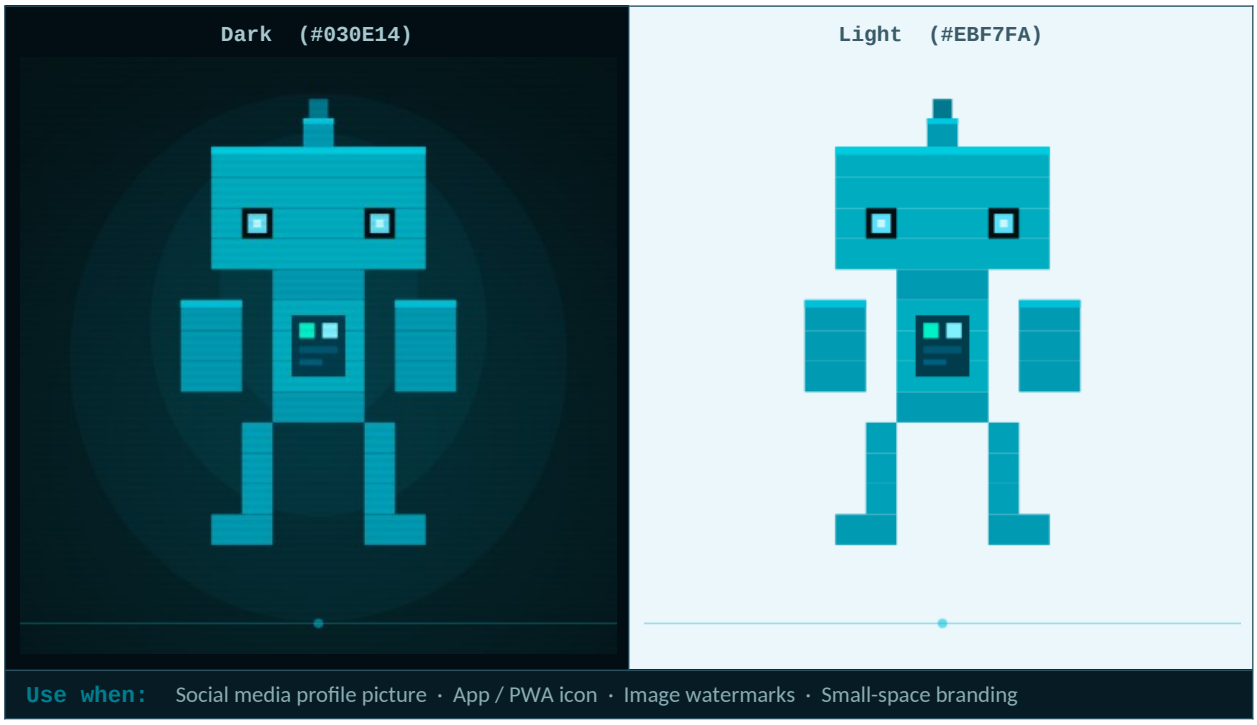
2.1 Logo Anatomy

The BSW logo is built from two primary elements: the Robot Mark and the Wordmark. Understanding the function of each element is essential to applying the logo correctly.

The Robot Mark	A pixel-art robot figure constructed entirely from rectangular blocks — a deliberate aesthetic reference to early computing and digital culture. The robot has two glowing eyes, visible arm joints, a chest display panel with LED indicators, and a subtle antenna. It is the brand's most distinctive visual asset.
The Wordmark	'BYTE-SIZED WISDOM' set in Orbitron Bold, all-caps, with extended letter-spacing. The wordmark appears in two lines: 'BYTE-SIZED' above 'WISDOM'. The wider letter-spacing on 'WISDOM' creates visual weight balance between the two lines.
The Divider Line	A horizontal line with three equidistant dot markers (endpoints and midpoint). This element separates the robot mark from the wordmark in the stacked variant and appears as a subtle structural device in other layouts. It references circuit board aesthetics.
The Glow Halo	A radial gradient emanating from behind the robot mark. This is a digital-only element and should not be simulated in print using halftones or screens. It communicates energy, technology, and the brand's digital-native character.

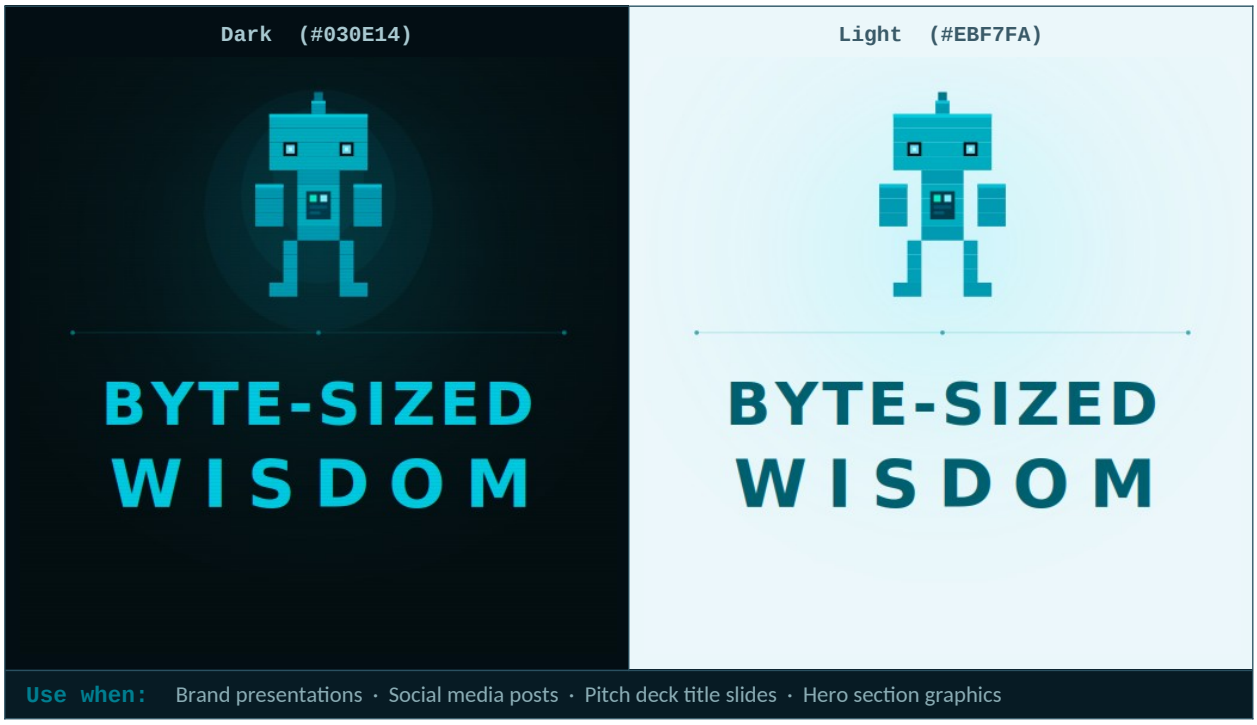
Logomark / Icon Only

The standalone robot mark. Used when the full name isn't needed but brand recognition still matters.



Stacked Logo

The primary lockup — robot above, BYTE-SIZED WISDOM below. Maximum visual impact. Default for all uses.



Horizontal Lockup

Robot left, name right — for contexts where vertical space is limited.

Dark Version



Light Version



Use when: Website navigation header · Email signatures · Document headers / letterhead · Banner ads

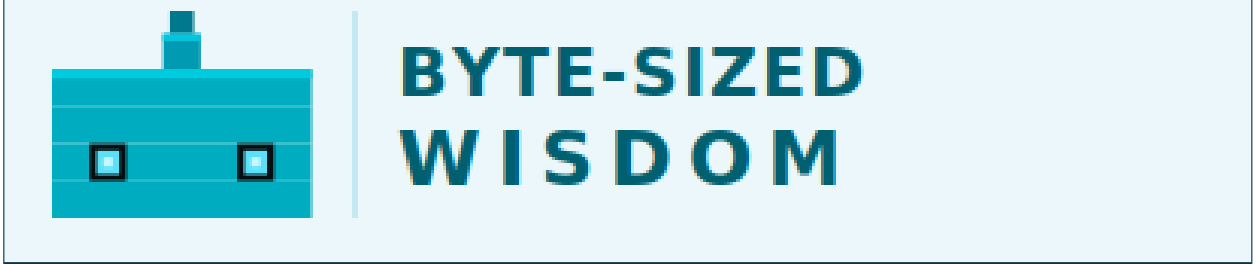
Mobile / Compact

Head-only mark with compressed text. Purpose-built for narrow digital spaces.

Dark Version



Light Version



Use when: Mobile navigation bars · App header bars · Sidebar branding · Compact UI contexts (< 280px wide)

Favicon System

Robot head in a rounded dark square. Delivered at every required size.



2.2 Logo Variants

Five official variants exist. Each has specific use cases. Do not create hybrid versions or invent new arrangements.

1. Primary — Stacked (Dark)	Robot mark centered above, divider line, BYTE-SIZED WISDOM below. Dark background (#030E14). This is the canonical logo. Use as the default whenever the context allows. Required for: brand presentations, social media profile pictures (as logomark), pitch decks.
2. Primary — Stacked (Light)	Identical layout on light background (#EBF7FA). Use when the dark version would be placed on a white or light-colored surface. Required for: letterhead, light-mode PDFs, light email templates.
3. Horizontal Lockup (Dark)	Robot mark on the left, vertical divider line, BYTE-SIZED / WISDOM stacked text on the right. Proportioned for wide contexts. Use for: website navigation header (primary position), email signatures (dark templates), banner ads, YouTube channel art.
4. Horizontal Lockup (Light)	Same layout on light background. Use for: email signatures on white, letterhead header position, light-mode website navigation.
5. Mobile / Compact	Robot head (antenna + head only, no body) on the left, compressed two-line text on the right. For contexts narrower than 280px or where the full robot is visually too dominant. Use for: mobile app headers, browser extension icons (large), sidebar brand marks, cookie consent bars.
6. Favicon	Robot head rendered in a rounded dark square (#030E14, 18% corner radius). Available at 16×16, 32×32, and 180×180px. Exclusively for: browser tab icons, PWA manifest icons, Apple touch icons, bookmark icons. Never use at sizes larger than 180×180px — at larger sizes use the Logomark variant instead.

2.3 Clear Space

Clear space is the minimum unoccupied area that must surround the logo on all sides. No text, imagery, borders, patterns, or other graphic elements may appear within this zone.

> **Clear Space Rule:**
> The minimum clear space on all sides equals the height of the Robot Mark's head unit. On the stacked logo at 200px wide, this is approximately 16px on each side. Scale this measurement proportionally as the logo scales.

For the horizontal lockup, clear space equals one full robot-head height above and below, and one full robot body width to the left and right.

For the favicon, clear space equals 25% of the favicon container dimension on each side.

2.4 Sizing — Minimum Dimensions

Stacked Logo — Digital	Min. 120px wide. Below this, the wordmark becomes illegible. If space is tighter than 120px wide, use the Favicon variant instead.
Stacked Logo — Print	Min. 32mm wide. Below this, request a vector proof from your print vendor before committing to a production run.
Horizontal Lockup — Digital	Min. 200px wide. At this size the wordmark and robot mark remain clearly distinct.
Horizontal Lockup — Print	Min. 55mm wide.
Mobile / Compact — Digital	Min. 160px wide. Not approved for print — the head truncation is a digital-only simplification.
Favicon — Digital	Min. 16×16px. At this size the robot head is reduced to a recognizable pixel pattern. Never below 16px.

2.5 Logo Color Modes

Full Color Dark	Primary usage. Robot in brand teal palette on #030E14 background. All color values as specified. Use whenever the dark background is appropriate.
Full Color Light	Robot in brand teal palette on #EBF7FA background. Text in #006070 (darker for contrast). Use on white/light surfaces only.
Single Color — Cyan	All logo elements rendered in #00C4D4 on dark background. Use when the full-color version cannot be reproduced (screen printing, embroidery, single-color print runs).

Single Color — Dark	All logo elements rendered in #1C3040 on light/white background. Use for single-color print on light stock, legal documents, or fax/photocopy contexts.
Reversed — White	All logo elements in #FFFFFF on any solid dark background. Use when placing the logo on a brand-colored background that is not the standard dark (#030E14).

2.6 Logo Misuse

The following are strictly prohibited. Any logo file that has been modified in these ways must be discarded and rebuilt from approved source files.

✓ DO

- Use only the six approved variants — never create new arrangements
- Maintain the original proportions — always scale uniformly
- Use approved color combinations only
- Source logos only from the official brand file package
- Allow full clear space on all sides without exception

✗ DON'T

- Recolor the robot, wordmark, or divider in any unapproved color
- Stretch, skew, rotate, or apply perspective to any element
- Apply drop shadows, glows, outlines, or gradients not in the source file
- Place the logo on a background with insufficient contrast
- Separate the robot mark from the wordmark in an unapproved way
- Animate or distort the logo for social media trend effects
- Place other logos, icons, or text within the clear space zone
- Reproduce the logo from memory using system fonts — always use the SVG

03

Color System

The language of the brand in color

The BSW color system is built on a single-hue cyan ramp — six progressively lighter tones of blue-green on a near-black teal base. This is not an arbitrary aesthetic choice. Each color has a precisely defined role in the hierarchy, and using a color outside its defined role breaks the visual logic of the system.

3.1 Primary Brand Palette

Background
#030E14
RGB 3, 14, 20
CMYK 85,30,0,92
HSL 201°, 74%, 5%
Page bg / deep surface

Radial Glow
#0A2E3A
RGB 10, 46, 58
CMYK 83,21,0,77
HSL 196°, 71%, 13%
Elevated surface / gradient

Shadow Cyan
#007E90
RGB 0, 126, 144
CMYK 100,13,0,44
HSL 187°, 100%, 28%
Borders / dividers

Accent Teal
#009EAE
RGB 0, 158, 174
CMYK 100,9,0,32
HSL 185°, 100%, 34%
Icons / secondary UI

Primary Cyan
#00C4D4
RGB 0, 196, 212
CMYK 100,8,0,17
HSL 184°, 100%, 42%
Buttons / links / CTAs

Highlight
#2AE8F5
RGB 42, 232, 245
CMYK 83,5,0,4
HSL 184°, 90%, 56%
Hover / emphasis (dark bg only)

3.2 Text & Neutral Palette

Primary Text
#D8EEF2
RGB 216, 238, 242
CMYK 11,2,0,5
Never on white/light
Headings — dark bg only

Secondary Text
#8AACB4
RGB 138, 172, 180
CMYK 23,4,0,29
Never on white/light
Body — dark bg only

Muted Text
#4A7A8A
RGB 74, 122, 138
CMYK 46,12,0,46
Never on white/light
Captions — dark bg only

Body Dark
#1C3040
RGB 28, 48, 64
CMYK 56,25,0,75

Muted Dark
#3A5A68
RGB 58, 90, 104
CMYK 44,13,0,59

Light Surface
#EBF7FA
RGB 235, 247, 250
CMYK 6,1,0,2

On white ONLY	On white ONLY	Light version bg
All text on white/light bg	*Captions on white/light bg*	*Light bg / logo bg (light)*

3.3 Color Psychology

Color choices are never arbitrary. The BSW palette was selected based on the psychological associations of blue-green (cyan-teal) in technology and professional contexts.

Trust & Reliability	Blue-greens are consistently associated with trust across cultures. This is why banks, healthcare, and enterprise tech companies default to blue. BSW uses a desaturated, sophisticated variant — not a 'corporate blue' — because the audience are small business owners who have seen through generic branding.
Technology & Innovation	Cyan and teal carry strong associations with digital displays, screens, and technology. The near-black background reinforces this — it evokes terminal interfaces, data visualization, and premium tech products.
Intelligence & Clarity	The high contrast between near-black and bright cyan is optically sharp. It communicates precision, not softness. This is deliberate — BSW is a direct, intelligent brand, not a warm and fuzzy one.
Premium & Exclusivity	Dark-mode interfaces are consistently perceived as more premium than light-mode equivalents. The deep #030E14 base creates a sense of sophistication that light backgrounds cannot match in the technology space.

3.4 Color Hierarchy & Usage Rules

Every color in the system has exactly one primary function. Using colors outside their defined role creates visual confusion.

#030E14 Background	The stage everything else sits on. Never use as text color. Never use on light backgrounds.
#0A2E3A Radial Glow	For elevated surfaces, card backgrounds, and the glow gradient behind the robot mark. Not for text.
#007E90 Shadow Cyan	Borders, dividers, subtle structural elements, and the divider line in the logo. Can be used as text color only on dark backgrounds, and only for de-emphasized content (never primary body text).
#009EAE Accent Teal	Icon fills, secondary interactive elements, label accents, and section markers on dark backgrounds. On white, only for large text (>18pt/24px) due to contrast limitations.
#00C4D4 Primary Cyan	The brand's primary action color. All primary buttons, all text links on dark backgrounds, active navigation states, and key data highlights. On white bg: sufficient contrast for large text only.

#2AE8F5 Highlight	The brightest brand color — reserved for maximum emphasis: CTA buttons, hover states, the highest-importance callouts, and the logo wordmark on dark backgrounds. Never use as body text on any background. Never use on white (insufficient contrast).
#D8EEF2 Primary Text	Main body text on dark backgrounds. Never on white or any light surface — it disappears.
#8AACB4 Secondary Text	Subheadings, supporting text, metadata on dark backgrounds. Not for white/light bg.
#1C3040 Body Dark	The only approved text color for body copy on white/light backgrounds. Use this wherever text meets a light surface.

3.5 Accessibility — WCAG Contrast Ratios

All color combinations used in BSW materials must meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA as a minimum. Level AAA is required for body text. The following combinations are pre-approved and tested.

Combination	Contrast Ratio	WCAG Level
#D8EEF2 on #030E14	12.8 : 1	AAA ✓
#2AE8F5 on #030E14	11.2 : 1	AAA ✓
#00C4D4 on #030E14	7.4 : 1	AAA ✓
#8AACB4 on #030E14	5.1 : 1	AA ✓
#1C3040 on #FFFFFF	12.1 : 1	AAA ✓
#3A5A68 on #FFFFFF	7.3 : 1	AAA ✓
#006878 on #FFFFFF	5.6 : 1	AA ✓
#007E90 on #FFFFFF	4.6 : 1	AA ✓ (large text only)
#009EAE on #FFFFFF	3.4 : 1	FAIL — large text only, >24px
#00C4D4 on #FFFFFF	2.8 : 1	FAIL — never use as text on white
#2AE8F5 on #FFFFFF	1.9 : 1	FAIL — never use as text on white
#D8EEF2 on #FFFFFF	1.3 : 1	FAIL — never use as text on white

3.6 The Brand Gradient

One gradient is approved for use: the Radial Glow — a soft radial gradient from #0A2E3A to transparent, centered behind the robot mark in digital contexts.

Gradient Rules:

> The Radial Glow may only appear behind the robot mark as an atmospheric element. It is not a background treatment for content sections, cards, or buttons. Do not create linear gradients from brand colors. Do not apply the gradient to text.

3.7 Approved Color Combinations

Dark card on dark bg	#0A2432 surface on #030E14 background — standard card/panel treatment
Cyan border on dark	#007E90 borders on #030E14 or #0A2432 — structural dividers and card borders
Primary text on dark	#D8EEF2 headings + #8AACB4 body on #030E14 — all dark-mode content
Cyan CTA on dark	#00C4D4 button bg + #030E14 button text — primary action button
Body on white	#1C3040 body + #006878 headings on #FFFFFF — all light-surface content
Light card on white	#EBF7FA card on #FFFFFF page — subtle elevation on light surfaces
Teal border on white	#007E90 at 40% opacity borders on white — structural elements

04

Typography

Two typefaces. Infinite combinations.

The BSW type system uses exactly two typefaces. Every piece of branded communication uses only these two fonts. No exceptions. No 'close enough' substitutes from system fonts.

4.1 Display Typeface — Orbitron

BYTE-SIZED WISDOM

AI · BRAND · WEB

Orbitron is a geometric sans-serif typeface with a distinctly technological character. Its squared letterforms, consistent stroke weight, and wide proportions give it an authoritative, futuristic presence that is immediately recognizable as the BSW voice in display contexts.

Full name	Orbitron
Classification	Geometric Sans-Serif
Designer	Matt McInerney — Google Fonts
License	Open Font License — free for commercial use
Download	fonts.google.com/specimen/Orbitron
Approved weights	700 Bold only — no other weights are approved
Approved case	UPPERCASE ONLY — sentence case is never approved in Orbitron
Letter-spacing	Always add tracking: +4 to +12px depending on size. Never use default tracking.
Usage contexts	Logo wordmark, section display headings (H1/H2 on dark bg), pull quotes, feature callouts, pricing displays, section labels
Prohibited uses	Body text of any length, small UI labels under 14pt, anything requiring mixed case
Web fallback	font-family: 'Orbitron', 'Courier New', monospace
Print notes	Requires professional print proof — some smaller sizes need tracking adjustment for optical balance

4.2 Body Typeface — Plus Jakarta Sans

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

We help businesses that are great at what they do actually look like it.

Plus Jakarta Sans is a humanist geometric sans-serif designed for high legibility across digital and print contexts. Its proportions are slightly condensed compared to similar typefaces, making it efficient in limited space while remaining open and approachable at reading sizes.

Full name	Plus Jakarta Sans
Classification	Humanist Geometric Sans-Serif
Designer	Tokotype — Google Fonts
License	Open Font License — free for commercial use
Download	fonts.google.com/specimen/Plus+Jakarta+Sans
Available weights	300 ExtraLight · 400 Regular · 500 Medium · 600 SemiBold · 700 Bold · 800 ExtraBold
Primary usage	All body text, UI labels, navigation items, form inputs, captions, footnotes, print copy, marketing copy
Heading usage	H3 and below on both dark and light backgrounds
Line height	1.65–1.75 for body text (16px line height for 11pt text). 1.1–1.2 for display headings.
Letter-spacing	Body: 0 to +0.3px. Labels/caps: +0.8 to +1.5px. Never negative tracking.
Web fallback	font-family: 'Plus Jakarta Sans', 'Segoe UI', 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif
Print notes	Regular (400) for body, SemiBold (600) for subheadings, Bold (700) for section headings in print

4.3 Type Scale — Complete Hierarchy

This scale governs all BSW communications. The dark/light columns specify which text color to use on that background type.

Type Role	Dark Background	Light / White Background
Display H1 72px Orbitron 700	#2AE8F5 Highlight	#030E14 Near-Black
Hero H1 56px Orbitron 700	#2AE8F5 Highlight	#030E14 Near-Black
Section H1 44px Orbitron 700	#00C4D4 Primary Cyan	#030E14 Near-Black

Section H2 36px Orbitron 700	#00C4D4 Primary Cyan	#006878 Dark Teal
Sub-Section H3 28px PJS 700	#D8EEF2 Primary Text	#1C3040 Body Dark
Block Heading H4 22px PJS 600	#8AACB4 Secondary Text	#007E90 Shadow Cyan
Body Large 18px PJS 400	#D8EEF2 Primary Text	#1C3040 Body Dark
Body Standard 16px PJS 400	#8AACB4 Secondary Text	#3A5A68 Muted Dark
Body Small 14px PJS 400	#4A7A8A Muted Text	#3A5A68 Muted Dark
UI Label (caps) 12px PJS 600	#4A7A8A Muted Text	#3A5A68 Muted Dark
Caption 11px PJS 400	#4A7A8A Muted Text	#3A5A68 Muted Dark
Code / Mono 14px Courier New	#2AE8F5 Highlight	#006878 Dark Teal

4.4 Typography Do's & Don'ts

✓ DO

- Always load fonts from Google Fonts CDN for web — never self-host without licensing review
- Use Orbitron exclusively in UPPERCASE — it was designed for all-caps contexts
- Apply letter-spacing to all Orbitron usage — minimum +4px at 24pt
- Set body text at minimum 14px / 10.5pt — never smaller in any context
- Use Plus Jakarta Sans 400 or 500 for body, 700 for headings
- Test all text on its actual background for contrast before publishing

✗ DON'T

- Mix Orbitron and Plus Jakarta Sans in the same headline
- Use Orbitron for body text — it is a display face, not a reading face
- Use system fonts (Arial, Helvetica) as substitutes — they break the brand feel
- Set justified alignment — always use left-align for body text
- Use italic Orbitron — no italic variant is approved
- Apply different fonts for 'variety' — two fonts is the system, not a limitation

05

Grid & Spacing

The invisible structure behind every layout

Spacing is not decoration — it is structure. Every spacing decision in BSW materials follows an 8px base unit system. Consistent spacing creates visual rhythm, signals quality, and makes layouts easier to scan.

5.1 Base Unit

> **The 8px Rule:**
> All spacing values are multiples of 8: 8, 16, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64, 80, 96, 128. Never use arbitrary spacing values like 10px, 15px, or 22px. These break the rhythm.

5.2 Spacing Scale

4px — Micro	Internal element padding (icon-to-label gap, badge padding). Minimum usable spacing.
8px — XS	Tight groupings: related icon + text, radio buttons, checkboxes, tag lists.
16px — S	Standard component padding (card internal), related content groups, form field gap.
24px — M	Section separation within a card, between a heading and its first paragraph.
32px — L	Between separate components on the same row, between card groups.
48px — XL	Between major content sections within a page, section header to content.
64px — 2XL	Between major page sections (hero to features, features to testimonials).
80px — 3XL	Top and bottom page section padding (mobile). Standard section vertical rhythm.
96px — 4XL	Top and bottom section padding (desktop standard).
128px — 5XL	Large hero sections, cover pages, major visual breaks.

5.3 Layout Grid

Desktop (>1200px)	12-column grid. Column width: auto. Gutter: 24px. Max content width: 1160px. Page margins: auto (centered).
Tablet (768–1200px)	8-column grid. Gutter: 20px. Content: fluid to container.
Mobile (<768px)	4-column grid. Gutter: 16px. Content: fluid, 16px margin each side.
Print (Letter)	Single column. Content width: 6.5 inches (9,360 DXA). Margins: 0.75 inches each side.
Business card	Safe zone: 0.125" inset from edge. Content zone: 3.25" × 1.75".

5.4 Content Width Guidelines

Maximum line length for body text is 75 characters (approximately 640px at 16px/400 weight). Lines longer than this measurably reduce reading speed and comprehension.

Optimal body width	560–680px / 60–75 characters per line
Hero headline width	720–840px / wraps naturally at 2–3 lines for visual impact
Card content width	Inherit card width minus 2× card padding
Full-width sections	Content container max-width: 1160px regardless of viewport
Single-column print	6.5 inches — approximately 65–70 characters per line at 11pt

06

Iconography

Small details that carry the brand

Icons are a secondary brand element — they support communication, they don't lead it. BSW icons must feel consistent with the overall aesthetic: precise, geometric, minimal, and technological.

6.1 Icon Style Specification

Style	Outline (line) icons — not filled, not duotone, not illustrated
Stroke weight	1.5px at 24px size, 2px at 32px+. Scale proportionally.
Corner radius	2px — slightly rounded, never sharp 90° angles, never pill-shaped
Design grid	24×24px optical grid. All icons have 2px optical padding within the grid.
Scale increments	16, 20, 24, 32, 40, 48px. Always scale at these increments only.
Style consistency	Never mix outline and filled icons in the same visual context
Active / Selected state	Fill the icon with the icon's current text color — do not add outlines
Disabled state	60% opacity of the default icon color

6.2 Approved Icon Libraries

Lucide Icons (Primary)	lucide.dev — MIT license. 1000+ icons. Consistent 24px grid, 2px stroke, rounded corners. This is the default BSW icon set.
Heroicons (Secondary)	heroicons.com — MIT license. Use when Lucide doesn't have a required icon. Heroicons Outline only — never Heroicons Solid in the same context as Lucide.
Custom icons	Any custom icon must be designed on the 24px grid with the same stroke weight and corner radius as Lucide. Submit for brand review before production use.

Prohibited sets	Font Awesome (too varied stylistically), Bootstrap Icons (too generic), Flaticon (inconsistent licensing), emoji as UI icons.

6.3 Icon Color Usage

Icon color follows the same rules as text — the background determines which icon colors are available.

Dark bg — Primary	#00C4D4 Primary Cyan — for interactive icons, feature icons, CTA icons
Dark bg — Secondary	#8AACB4 Secondary Text — for supporting icons, metadata icons, decorative context
Dark bg — Muted	#4A7A8A Muted Text — for disabled icons, de-emphasized UI elements
Light bg — Primary	#007E90 Shadow Cyan — primary icon color on white/light surfaces
Light bg — Secondary	#3A5A68 Muted Dark — supporting icons on white surfaces
Light bg — Muted	#3A5A68 at 60% opacity — disabled/de-emphasized on light surfaces
Never	Multi-color icons, gradient-filled icons, icons in #2AE8F5 on white, icons in #D8EEF2 on white

07

Photography & Imagery

The visual world the brand lives in

Photography is used sparingly in BSW materials — the brand is primarily graphic and typographic. When photography appears, it must feel like it belongs in the same world as the dark, technical, premium aesthetic. A warm, sunny stock photo will destroy the brand impression that the rest of the system builds.

7.1 Photography Style

Lighting	Dark, directional lighting. Single or dual light sources. High contrast between lit and shadow areas. No flat, evenly lit studio photography.
Color temperature	Cool to neutral (5000–6500K). Never warm. Apply a subtle cyan/teal color grade (+10 to +20 teal in Lightroom/Photoshop) to integrate with brand palette.
Saturation	Desaturated — approximately 70–80% of original saturation. Slight boost to cyan/teal channel only.
Subject matter	Technology (hardware, screens, circuits), architectural geometry, abstract data patterns, working environments with visible screens/monitors, close-up detail shots of technical subjects.
People	If people appear: working or in context (not posed). Facial expressions: focused, engaged, thoughtful. Never smiling at camera.
Composition	Geometric framing. Leading lines. Strong negative space. Rule-of-thirds with deliberate intent. Avoid centered symmetrical compositions.

7.2 Image Processing Requirements

All photography used in BSW materials must be processed to match the brand palette before use. Raw stock photography does not meet brand standards.

Step 1 — Exposure	Reduce overall exposure by 0.5–1.0 stops. The image should lean dark.
Step 2 — Shadows	Open shadows slightly (+15 to +25) so detail is not completely lost in dark areas.
Step 3 — Color grade	Shift mid-tone hue toward cyan/teal. In Lightroom: Hue Aqua +20, Saturation Aqua +15, Saturation All other channels -10.

Step 4 — Desaturate	Reduce overall Saturation by -20 to -30. Leave Luminance untouched.
Step 5 — Grain	Add subtle film grain (12–18 in Lightroom) to integrate with the brand's texture aesthetic.
Step 6 — Final check	Place on #030E14 background and verify the image feels like it belongs in the palette.

7.3 Text Overlay on Photography

Never place text directly on photography without an overlay treatment. Even a properly processed brand photo does not provide sufficient or consistent contrast for text.

Dark overlay method	Solid #030E14 at 55–70% opacity over the entire image, then place text using dark-background text colors.
Gradient overlay method	#030E14 radial or linear gradient from 80% opacity (text side) to 0% opacity. Use when the full image should remain visible on the non-text side.
Frosted method	Gaussian blur (radius 20px) + dark overlay at 40%. Suitable for modal backgrounds and overlay panels.
Prohibited	Any text directly on unprocessed photography. White text directly on bright areas. Orbitron at small sizes on photo backgrounds.

08

Patterns & Textures

The subtle layer beneath everything

BSW uses three texture elements to reinforce the digital, retro-tech character of the brand. These are atmospheric additions — never structural. They should be felt, not noticed.

8.1 CRT Scanline Pattern

Description	Alternating rows of 2px height: transparent / 6% black. Creates the horizontal line pattern of old CRT monitors and retro digital displays.
Usage	Applied as the topmost layer over dark background sections, logo presentations, and hero areas at 30–40% opacity.
Never use on	Light backgrounds. Photograph overlays (use grain instead). Text-only sections where readability is the only concern.
CSS implementation	background: repeating-linear-gradient(0deg, rgba(0,0,0,0.06) 0px, rgba(0,0,0,0.06) 2px, transparent 2px, transparent 4px)
Print equivalent	Not reproduced in print — screen-exclusive texture

8.2 Noise / Film Grain

Description	Uniform random pixel noise at 3–5% opacity over dark surfaces. Creates depth and prevents the flat, digital look of pure solid color backgrounds.
Usage	Backgrounds, card fills, and full-bleed dark sections. Subtle at 3–5% — if you can clearly see it, reduce opacity.
CSS implementation	SVG feTurbulence filter or PNG grain overlay tile at 2–4% opacity.
Print equivalent	Fine grain/noise at 3% is print-reproducible and should be applied to dark print backgrounds where flat tones would look amateur.

8.3 Radial Glow Effect

Description	A soft radial gradient from #0A2E3A to transparent (#030E14 base), centered behind focal content. Draws the eye without hard edges.
Primary usage	Behind the robot mark in all logo presentations. Behind the hero section focal point on the website.
Secondary usage	Behind feature icons in feature grids, behind highlighted statistics, behind pull quotes.
Sizing	Glow radius approximately 1.5–2× the width of the element it frames.
Never use	On light backgrounds. As a button style. As a background for text blocks (creates uneven contrast).

8.4 Circuit / Grid Dot Pattern

Description	A subtle grid of dots (2px circles, 32px spacing) at 4–8% opacity on dark backgrounds. References circuit boards and data grids.
Usage	Large hero sections, presentation backgrounds, and full-bleed promotional graphics where additional depth is needed.
Not suitable for	Cards, modals, or any surface where content density is high — the pattern will compete with content.
CSS implementation	radial-gradient(circle, rgba(0,196,212,0.08) 1px, transparent 1px) repeat at 32px 32px

09

Tone of Voice

How BSW communicates in words

The BSW brand is as much a voice as it is a visual identity. Inconsistent tone — even with perfect visual execution — breaks the brand impression. Every piece of written communication is a brand touchpoint.

Voice is consistent. Tone adapts. The brand's voice attributes are always present — confident, direct, intelligent, clear. But the tone shifts: a LinkedIn post is more formal than an Instagram caption. A proposal is more measured than a tweet. Understanding this distinction is essential.

9.1 Voice Attributes (Always Present)

Clear	Every sentence should be understood on first reading. If a sentence requires re-reading to parse, rewrite it. Preferred: active voice, subject-verb-object order, concrete nouns.
Confident	We do not hedge. We do not soften every statement with qualifiers. We have done this before and we know what works. Phrases to eliminate: 'might', 'could possibly', 'we think', 'in our opinion', 'perhaps'.
Direct	Lead with the point. The first sentence of any piece of copy must earn its place — it should tell the reader immediately why they should keep reading. No preamble. No 'Great question!'. No 'Welcome to our website.'
Intelligent	BSW communicates at the level of an informed, educated professional. We do not talk down, we do not over-simplify, and we do not use baby-talk analogies for technical concepts. The audience respects expertise.
Human	Professional does not mean robotic. BSW communications have a personality — a specific perspective, a slight edge, a point of view. We are not a committee. We are a person with opinions.

9.2 Vocabulary Guide

Words and Phrases to Use

Build / Create	Not 'leverage' or 'utilize'. We make things.
Clients	Not 'customers' or 'users'. We have relationships, not transactions.
System / Framework	We create things that scale and document — not one-off deliverables.

Modern / Professional	Specific and honest. Not 'world-class' or 'cutting-edge' (vague and overused).
Exactly / Precisely	Signals specificity and care. Use when describing process or deliverables.
Direct	We communicate without intermediary. Say what something is.

Words and Phrases to Avoid

Leverage / Utilize	Use 'use' instead. These are corporate padding words.
Synergy / Holistic	Meaningless filler that signals generic agency thinking.
World-class / Best-in-class	Unverifiable superlatives that every competitor uses.
Solutions	'We provide solutions' means nothing. Say what you actually do.
Passionate about	Every agency claims passion. Show it through specificity instead.
Move the needle / Circle back	Business jargon that dates immediately and sounds unoriginal.
Ideate / Learnings	Made-up corporate words. Use 'generate ideas' and 'lessons'.

9.3 Before & After — Rewrites

These examples show how the same information sounds in generic voice versus the BSW voice.

Example 1 — Service Description

Before (generic):

> *"We leverage our holistic approach to provide world-class brand solutions that synergize your visual identity with your core values to drive meaningful engagement with your target audience."*

After (BSW voice):

> *"We build brand systems that make your business look as good as it actually is — then document everything so it stays consistent as you grow."*

Example 2 — CTA Copy

Before (generic):

> *"Feel free to reach out to us today to learn more about our services and how we can help you achieve your business goals!"*

After (BSW voice):

> *"Book a 30-minute consultation. We'll map out exactly what your brand needs and what it would take to get there. No pitch, no obligation."*

Example 3 — Error Message

Before (generic):

> *"An error has occurred. Please try again later or contact support if the problem persists."*

After (BSW voice):

> *"Something didn't work. Try refreshing — if it keeps happening, email contact@bytesizedwisdom.com and we'll fix it."*

9.4 Platform-Specific Tone Guidance

Website body copy	Confident and clear. Medium formality. Long-form paragraphs where detail earns the space. Short paragraphs elsewhere. Lead with outcome, support with process.
Website CTAs	Action-forward. Outcome-specific. 3–7 words. 'Book a Free Consultation' not 'Contact Us'. 'See the Full System' not 'Learn More'.
LinkedIn posts	More formal register, but still with a point of view. Share an opinion, not just a fact. 150–300 words optimal. Ends with a question or a clear statement.
Email subject lines	Specific, direct, value-forward. Never click-bait. 'Your brand guidelines — delivered' over 'Important update about your project'.
Proposals	Most formal BSW context. Structured, specific, evidence-based. Still direct — no padding. Every sentence advances the argument for why the client should engage.
Social captions	Short, punchy, opinionated. A single strong point. No hashtag stuffing (max 3, relevant only). Can have more personality and edge than other channels.

10

Messaging Architecture

What BSW says and how it says it

10.1 Core Messaging

Tagline	Modern Branding. Intelligent Systems.
Positioning statement	We help small businesses and startups build professional brand identities and integrate AI into their operations — so they can compete with larger players and grow with confidence.
Elevator pitch (30 sec)	We help businesses that are great at what they do but struggle to look and communicate like it. We modernize the brand, build the web presence, and integrate AI into how they work — so they can focus on their business while we make sure the world takes them seriously.
Mission	To make premium brand strategy and AI integration accessible to every business, regardless of size — delivering enterprise-level quality with the directness and accountability of a true business partner.
One-line descriptor	AI consulting and brand identity for businesses that are ready to be taken seriously.

10.2 Value Propositions by Service

Logo System	A logo is a promise. Without a professional, consistent logo system, every touchpoint introduces doubt. We deliver a complete system — not a single file — so your mark works everywhere, at every size, forever.
Brand Color Palette	Color is the fastest brand signal humans process — faster than your logo. A strategic palette doesn't just look professional; it creates emotional associations that compound over time into recognition and trust.
Typography System	Inconsistent typography signals a business that doesn't pay attention to details. A documented type system ensures that anyone working on your brand — now or three years from now — maintains the same professional standard.
Brand Guidelines	The guidelines document is what separates a brand from a logo. Without it, every contractor, every new hire, and every platform produces a different version of your business. With it, consistency becomes automatic.
Website Design	Your website has 3 seconds to explain what you do, establish trust, and give a visitor a reason to stay. Most business websites fail all three. A conversion-focused website isn't a digital brochure — it's your best salesperson.

Social Media Branding	Social media is where most first impressions now happen. Inconsistent profiles tell the same story inconsistent business cards did in 1995 — that you're not paying attention. Templates and a defined system fix this permanently.
Business Card & Print	Physical materials are higher-trust touchpoints than digital equivalents. A premium business card that matches your digital brand signals that every detail of your business receives this level of attention.
Messaging & Voice	You can have the best brand visuals in your market and still lose clients because your website copy is vague, passive, and forgettable. Clear positioning and precise language is as important as any visual element.

10.3 Objection Responses

'I can't afford it right now'	'The cost of inconsistent branding isn't zero — it's paid in missed contracts and lost trust. A complete brand system is an investment that compounds: every client who sees it over the next 5 years receives the same professional impression.'
'I can get a logo on Fiverr for $20'	'You can. That gets you a single file. A brand system includes every variation you'll ever need, documented rules so it's used correctly, and the strategic thinking behind why each decision was made. That's a different product.'
'We'll do it later when we're bigger'	'The businesses you're competing with did it first. Brand consistency is one of the few things small businesses can actually match against larger competitors — it doesn't require a bigger budget, just a clear system.'
'Do we really need brand guidelines?'	'Without them, every time a contractor, a new hire, or a platform needs your logo, they make it up. Guidelines aren't bureaucracy — they're instructions that save you from inconsistency you'll otherwise spend years trying to undo.'
'We already have a logo'	'A logo is one asset. A brand system is the framework that makes every other asset — the website, the social media, the business card, the proposal template — feel like they come from the same company. Most businesses have the first but not the second.'

11

Brand Applications

How the brand lives in the real world

11.1 Business Card

The business card is the most tactile brand touchpoint. It should feel as premium as it looks. Both sides must adhere exactly to the specifications below.

Technical Specifications

Dimensions	3.5" × 2" (88.9 × 50.8 mm) — US standard business card size
Document resolution	300 DPI minimum. 350 DPI for premium print runs.
Color mode	CMYK for all print production. Use the CMYK values from Section 3 — do not convert from RGB/HEX.
Bleed	0.125" (3.175mm) on all four edges. Background color must extend to bleed line.
Safe zone	All text and logos must be 0.125" (3.175mm) inside the trim line. Total safe zone: 0.25" inset from edge.
Corner radius	0mm — square corners. Round-corner cards are not approved.

Front Side

Background	#030E14 full bleed. Subtle radial glow (#0A2E3A gradient) behind the robot area.
Logo position	Mini Horizontal Lockup — top-left safe zone. Head mark 32px tall equivalent.
Name	Aaron Zajicek. Plus Jakarta Sans Bold. 50pt equivalent. Color: #D8EEF2.
Title	Founder · Principal. Plus Jakarta Sans Medium. 17pt. Color: #009EAE.
Services line	AI Consulting · Brand Identity · Web Design. Plus Jakarta Sans Regular. 13pt. Color: #007E90.
Contact details	Email, website, location. Cyan dot bullet (3.5px, #00C4D4). Plus Jakarta Sans Regular. 15.5pt. Color: #8AACB4.
Robot mark	Large robot mark right side, scale 1.22×, centered at right third of card.
Edge treatment	Solid #009EAE line 3px at top and bottom edges.

Back Side

Background	#030E14 full bleed. Radial glow centered-left.
Robot mark	Large robot at scale 1.55×, centered in left 45% of card.
Vertical divider	0.6px #007E90 line separating robot from text area.
Brand name	BYTE-SIZED (56pt Orbitron) + WISDOM (62pt Orbitron). Color: #00cce4.
Services list	5 services in Plus Jakarta Sans 14.5pt, #009EAE.
CTA	'Start your transformation at' + aaronzajicek.com in Orbitron 19pt #2AE8F5.

Recommended Paper Stocks

Premium (standard)	16pt card stock with soft-touch matte laminate (one or both sides). Provides a velvet texture that reinforces the premium brand feel.
Standard	14pt card stock with UV gloss one side (front), matte reverse. Good balance of quality and cost.
Ultra-premium	18pt with spot UV on robot mark and brand name. Creates tactile emphasis on key brand elements. Recommended for client-facing contexts.
Avoid	Glossy both sides (fingerprint-prone), standard 80lb paper (too thin), linen or recycled textures (inconsistent with brand aesthetic).

11.2 Letterhead

Page size	US Letter 8.5" × 11"
Header	Horizontal Lockup (Light version) — top-left. 48pt-equivalent height. Margin: 0.75".
Header rule	1pt #007E90 horizontal line below header area.
Footer	contact@bytesizedwisdom.com · aaronzajicek.com · Katy, Texas. Plus Jakarta Sans Regular 9pt. Color: #3A5A68.
Footer rule	0.5pt #007E90 line above footer.
Body area	Plus Jakarta Sans Regular 11pt, #1C3040. 1.65 line height. 0.75" margins.
Background	White (#FFFFFF) — this is a light-surface application. Use Light logo variant only.
Page numbers	Plus Jakarta Sans Regular 9pt, #3A5A68, right-aligned in footer.

11.3 Email Signature

The email signature must use the Light version of the Horizontal Lockup. Email clients render on white backgrounds — the dark version will show its background color as a rectangle in most email clients.

Logo	Horizontal Lockup — Light version. Max 180px wide. PNG export, transparent background.
Separator	1px solid #007E90 border-bottom on a spacer element
Name	Aaron Zajicek. Plus Jakarta Sans Bold 14pt. Color: #1C3040.
Title	Founder · Principal, Byte-Sized Wisdom. Plus Jakarta Sans Regular 12pt. #3A5A68.
Contact	contact@bytesizedwisdom.com | aaronzajicek.com. 11pt. #007E90 (link-styled).
Location	Katy, Texas (Houston Metro). 11pt. #3A5A68.
Background	Transparent (inherits email white). Never set a dark background.
Max width	600px — same as standard email content width.
File format	HTML with inline CSS only — no external stylesheets (blocked by email clients).

11.4 Social Media Profile Standards

Profile picture	Logomark (icon only) on #030E14 background. Delivered as a perfect square. Content must remain visible after circular crop — robot mark centered, minimum 30% padding on each side.
LinkedIn banner	1584 × 396px. Horizontal Lockup left-anchored (left 55%). Robot mark may be visible as background element right side. Right 35% must be clear of all text and logos (hidden behind profile photo).
Twitter / X header	1500 × 500px. Same layout as LinkedIn. Text must be in left 60% only.
Facebook cover	820 × 312px. Horizontal Lockup centered or left-anchored. Ensure critical content is in center 560px (visible on all devices).
YouTube channel art	2560 × 1440px. Safe zone: 1546 × 423px centered. Horizontal Lockup in safe zone.
Instagram / profile pic	180 × 180px rendered at various sizes. Use Favicon variant — not the full logomark.

11.5 Social Media Post Templates

Standard post (square)	1080 × 1080px. Dark bg (#030E14). Headline in Orbitron Bold. Body in Plus Jakarta Sans. Subtle scanline texture. BSW Favicon mark bottom-right corner at 80px, 70% opacity.
Standard post (portrait)	1080 × 1350px. Same treatment as square, content repositioned for portrait format.
Landscape post	1200 × 628px. Used for LinkedIn article cards and Twitter link previews.
Story (9:16)	1080 × 1920px. Robot mark as background element at 40% opacity. Content in safe zone (top and bottom 14% are hidden on some platforms).
Reel cover	1080 × 1920px. Still frame design. Orbitron headline prominent. High contrast.
Carousel slide	1080 × 1080px. Consistent header/footer across all slides. Slide number bottom-left.
Consistent elements	Every post template uses the same: dark background, brand typography, cyan accent, favicon watermark. No post should be unidentifiable as BSW content.

11.6 Presentation Template

Slide size	16:9 widescreen (1920 × 1080px)
Title slide	Large Orbitron headline in #D8EEF2. Subtitle in Plus Jakarta Sans. Robot mark right side or background. #030E14 background with glow.
Section break slides	Cover-style: dark bg, large Orbitron section number + title, left border accent.
Content slides	#030E14 bg. Slide title in Orbitron 32pt #00C4D4. Body in Plus Jakarta Sans 20pt #8AACB4. Max 6 bullet points per slide. Left-aligned.
Data slides	Cyan (#00C4D4) as primary chart color. Dark teal (#007E90) for secondary data. White (#D8EEF2) labels. No grid lines — use white bars/dots only.
Footer	Every slide: BSW Horizontal Lockup bottom-left (light version at 80px wide), slide number bottom-right.

12

Digital Standards

Building the brand in code

12.1 CSS Custom Properties

All digital properties built for BSW must use these CSS custom property names. This ensures that if palette values change, they can be updated globally in one location.

--bsw-bg	#030E14 — Page background
--bsw-surface	#071B24 — Elevated surface
--bsw-card	#0A2432 — Card fill
--bsw-border	rgba(0,126,144,0.12) — Default border
--bsw-border-bright	rgba(42,232,245,0.28) — Hover/focus border
--bsw-dim	#007E90 — Shadow cyan
--bsw-accent	#009EAE — Accent teal
--bsw-primary	#00C4D4 — Primary cyan
--bsw-highlight	#2AE8F5 — Highlight cyan
--bsw-text	#D8EEF2 — Primary text (dark bg)
--bsw-text-mid	#8AACB4 — Secondary text (dark bg)
--bsw-text-muted	#4A7A8A — Muted text (dark bg)

12.2 Interactive Component States

Button — Default	Background: #00C4D4. Text: #030E14. Border-radius: 7px. Font: Plus Jakarta Sans 700. Padding: 13px 30px.

Button — Hover	Background: #2AE8F5. Transform: translateY(-1px). Box-shadow: 0 8px 28px rgba(0,196,212,0.28).
Button — Active	Background: #009EAE. Transform: none.
Button — Disabled	Background: #007E90 at 50% opacity. Text: #030E14 at 60%. Cursor: not-allowed.
Button — Secondary	Background: transparent. Border: 1px solid rgba(0,126,144,0.28). Text: #00C4D4. Hover: border-color #00C4D4, bg rgba(0,196,212,0.07).
Input — Default	Background: #071B24. Border: 1px solid rgba(0,126,144,0.12). Text: #D8EEF2. Placeholder: #4A7A8A.
Input — Focus	Border-color: #00C4D4. Outline: none. Box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(0,196,212,0.12).
Link — Default	Color: #00C4D4. Text-decoration: none.
Link — Hover	Color: #2AE8F5. Text-decoration: underline.
Nav link — Active	Color: #2AE8F5. Font-weight: 600.

12.3 Animation Principles

Motion in BSW digital properties must feel precise and purposeful — never flashy or attention-seeking. Animation is a functional tool, not decoration.

Duration — micro	150–200ms. Button states, hover changes, checkbox toggles.
Duration — standard	250–350ms. Modal open/close, dropdown, tooltip, card hover.
Duration — page	400–550ms. Page transitions, section reveals, major layout changes.
Easing	ease (default), ease-out (entering elements), ease-in (exiting elements). Never linear for UI. Never bounce or elastic.
Hover transforms	translateY(-1px) to -3px for interactive cards. Never more than -4px.
Entrance animations	Fade + translateY(20px → 0). Stagger delay: 60–80ms between sequential elements.
Prohibited	Auto-playing loops on non-background elements. Rotation (except loading spinners). Parallax effects that cause jank on mobile.

13

Print Standards

Getting it right when it's permanent

Print is unforgiving. A digital file can be updated; a business card run of 500 cannot. Follow all print specifications precisely before approving any print run.

13.1 Color Mode Requirements

All print-production files must be in CMYK color mode. RGB and HEX values render unpredictably in print. The CMYK conversions below are calculated for coated stock on a standard commercial printing press. Values may require minor adjustment for uncoated stock or digital (inkjet/toner) printing.

HEX #030E14 Background	CMYK: 85, 30, 0, 92 (very dark — allow for dot gain on dark areas)
HEX #007E90 Shadow Cyan	CMYK: 100, 13, 0, 44
HEX #009EAE Accent Teal	CMYK: 100, 9, 0, 32
HEX #00C4D4 Primary Cyan	CMYK: 100, 8, 0, 17
HEX #2AE8F5 Highlight	CMYK: 83, 5, 0, 4 (very close to process cyan — request proof)
HEX #D8EEF2 Primary Text	CMYK: 11, 2, 0, 5 (near-white — ensure minimum 4pt on dark bg)
HEX #8AACB4 Secondary Text	CMYK: 23, 4, 0, 29
HEX #1C3040 Body Dark	CMYK: 56, 25, 0, 75

13.2 File Format Requirements

Vector source	SVG (web) or PDF/EPS (print). All logos, icons, and geometric shapes must be supplied as vectors. Never rasterize and enlarge.

Print-production files	PDF/X-1a or PDF/X-4. Embed all fonts. Convert all colors to CMYK. Include bleed and crop marks.
Image resolution	300 DPI minimum at final print size. 350 DPI for premium stock or specialty printing. 600 DPI for fine-detail elements like fine lines.
Black definition	Rich black for large solid areas: C40 M30 Y30 K100. Pure black K100 for text only. Never use registration black (C100 M100 Y100 K100) on anything except registration marks.
Fonts	Embed all fonts or convert text to outlines before submitting to print vendor. Never rely on vendor having the font installed.

13.3 Paper Stock Guidance

Business cards	100–130lb cover stock minimum. Soft-touch matte laminate recommended. Silk laminate acceptable. Avoid glossy (fingerprints) and linen (texture inconsistent with brand).
Letterhead	24lb bond or 32lb writing stock. White only. Subtle watermark acceptable if it doesn't conflict with brand elements.
Brochures	100lb gloss text (inside), 100lb gloss cover (cover pages). Or 80lb matte text for a more subdued finish.
Flyers	80–100lb gloss text. Single-sided: gloss one side, uncoated reverse for writing. Double-sided: gloss both sides.
Presentations (printed)	120lb matte cover stock for covers, 80lb text for interior pages. Saddle-stitch or perfect bound depending on page count.

13.4 Recommended Print Vendors

Moo.com	Recommended for business cards. Premium finish options (Soft Touch, Luxe, Gold Foil). Higher cost, exceptional quality. Upload-ready with online proof tool.
Smartpress	Recommended for brochures, letterhead, and presentation materials. High color accuracy, wide stock selection, B2B pricing.
Vistaprint	Acceptable for standard flyers and basic materials. Not recommended for business cards or premium materials — quality inconsistent.
Local commercial printer	Preferred for large runs, specialty finishing (spot UV, emboss, foil), and same-day/next-day needs. Provide PDF/X-1a files and request a hard proof before production run.

14

File Management

Keeping the brand system organized

A brand system is only useful if the files can be found, understood, and used correctly. Every file in the BSW brand package follows these naming conventions and folder structures.

14.1 File Naming Convention

Naming Format:
[brand]-[asset-type]-[variant]-[color-mode].[extension]

bsw-logo-stacked-dark.svg	Primary stacked logo, dark version, vector source
bsw-logo-stacked-light.svg	Primary stacked logo, light version, vector source
bsw-logo-horizontal-dark.png	Horizontal lockup, dark, raster export
bsw-logo-horizontal-light.png	Horizontal lockup, light, raster export
bsw-logo-horizontal-transparent.png	Horizontal lockup, no background, transparent PNG
bsw-logo-mobile-dark.svg	Mobile/compact variant, dark
bsw-favicon.svg	Favicon master vector
bsw-favicon-16.png	Favicon at 16×16px
bsw-favicon-32.png	Favicon at 32×32px
bsw-favicon-180.png	Favicon at 180×180px (Apple Touch Icon)

bsw-card-front.svg	Business card front, editable SVG
bsw-card-back.svg	Business card back, editable SVG

14.2 Recommended Folder Structure

01-brand-guidelines/	Brand guidelines PDF + source document (this file)
02-logo-system/	All logo SVG source files and PNG exports, organized by variant
02-logo-system/dark/	All dark-version logo files
02-logo-system/light/	All light-version logo files
02-logo-system/transparent/	All transparent-bg PNG exports
02-logo-system/favicon/	All favicon sizes (16, 32, 180px) + SVG
03-color-palette/	Color swatches in ASE (Adobe), Figma, and PNG formats
04-typography/	Font files (OTF/TTF) + font specimen PDF
05-templates/	Editable templates for business card, letterhead, social media
05-templates/social-media/	Post templates by platform
05-templates/print/	Business card, letterhead, flyer source files
06-photography/	Approved/processed brand photography
07-exports/	Final production-ready export files for active projects

14.3 Version Control

Document versioning	Major versions (v1.0, v2.0) for significant brand updates. Minor versions (v1.1, v1.2) for corrections and additions.

File versioning	Date-stamp working files: bsw-card-front-20250515-v2.svg. Final production files drop the date: bsw-card-front.svg
Archive policy	Previous major versions are kept in an /archive/ folder for reference. They are never used for production without explicit approval.
Distribution	Share files via Google Drive folder with view-only access for contractors. Full edit access for approved partners only.
Update notifications	When guidelines are updated, notify all active contractors and partners via email with a summary of changes.

15

Quick Reference

Everything important on one page

Color Values

Background	Shadow Cyan	Primary Cyan	Highlight
#030E14	#007E90	#00C4D4	#2AE8F5
CMYK 85,30,0,92	CMYK 100,13,0,44	CMYK 100,8,0,17	CMYK 83,5,0,4
RGB 3,14,20	RGB 0,126,144	RGB 0,196,212	RGB 42,232,245
Page / deep surface	*Borders / dividers*	*Buttons / links*	*CTA / emphasis (dark only)*

Primary Text	Secondary Text	Body Dark	Light Surface
#D8EEF2	#8AACB4	#1C3040	#EBF7FA
CMYK 11,2,0,5	CMYK 23,4,0,29	CMYK 56,25,0,75	CMYK 6,1,0,2
RGB 216,238,242	RGB 138,172,180	RGB 28,48,64	RGB 235,247,250
On dark backgrounds ONLY	*On dark backgrounds ONLY*	*On white/light ONLY*	*Light bg / light logo*

Contrast Quick Reference

Background	Safe text colors	Never use
#030E14 (dark)	#D8EEF2 · #8AACB4 · #2AE8F5 · #00C4D4	#030E14 · #1C3040 · #3A5A68
#FFFFFF (white)	#1C3040 · #3A5A68 · #006878 · #007E90	#00C4D4 · #2AE8F5 · #D8EEF2 · #8AACB4
#009EAE (mid)	#030E14 (dark text only)	Any light or mid-range color

Typefaces

Orbitron 700 (display)	Logo wordmark · H1/H2 display on dark · Callouts · UPPERCASE ONLY · fonts.google.com/specimen/Orbitron
Plus Jakarta Sans 300–700	All body text · UI labels · navigation · print copy · web fallback: 'Segoe UI', Arial, sans-serif

Courier New (mono)	Code samples · technical specifications · web fallback only

Contact & Resources

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Location	Katy, Texas (Houston Metro)
Brand files	Logo SVGs, font files, Figma source, templates — available on request
Document	Brand Guidelines v1.0 — 2025 — Byte-Sized Wisdom

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Questions about brand usage: contact@bytesizedwisdom.com